



2ND WEEK: **DAY 10**

Getting checked

YOUR BABY TODAY

Sometimes babies develop skin rashes or irritations and sore bottoms around this time. Your pediatrician can advise on how to relieve these minor problems.

“If you find that you need some additional help with the baby, there are several options to consider.”

Adjusting to life with a newborn is difficult for some mothers, especially those recovering from Cesareans. Sleep deprivation may make it hard to handle all of the new responsibilities. If your partner took time off during the first week, you may want another pair of hands to take their place. If you're able to hire a babysitter or visiting nurse for a few hours a day, you'll get some relief. If not, consider asking a good friend or relative for assistance. But before calling in any favors, make sure that the person you ask will actually provide the type of help you need. Do you want someone to care for the baby so you can nap, make dinner, or run errands? Do you want someone to cook or clean while you tend to the baby? Do you need someone to get groceries and pick up your older child? Be clear about your needs so your helper isn't upset that they won't get to hold the baby the whole time.

Your baby loves to be stimulated. They can focus about a foot away and will watch a simple object such as a mobile. Babies soon recognize familiar faces and will love to watch you talk. Being part of your daily life provides plenty of stimulation. Tell them what you are doing and your plans for the day, read stories, and listen to music together. When they're awake, give them time on their tummy to develop strength in the arms and prevent a “flat” head, a common problem in babies who spend a lot of time on their backs. Always supervise your baby while they are on their tummy.

YOUR BABY'S SLEEP PATTERN

Newborns have at least two naps each day and many simply rotate sleeping and eating throughout the day. In the early days, you'll find that there is little routine to your baby's sleep pattern since they can't go long without being fed.

Your baby won't be picky about where they nap, whether in the car, stroller, or a baby sling. At home, you may prefer to put your baby somewhere quiet, such as in their Moses basket or bassinet, or you might want to keep them close by.